

Exclusive

Anthropic in Talks to Buy AI Chips From U.K. Startup

Anthropic 洽谈从英国初创公司购买 AI 芯片



Anthropic co-founder and president, Daniela Amodei. Kimberly White/Getty Images.

Anthropic 联合创始人兼总裁 Daniela Amodei. Kimberly White/Getty Images.

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As Anthropic's sales explode, straining the servers it uses, the company is considering adding another source of AI server chips in addition to existing

suppliers Google, Amazon and Nvidia.

随着 **Anthropic** 的销售额呈爆炸式增长，其使用的服务器压力倍增，该公司正考虑在现有供应商 **Google**、**Amazon** 和 **Nvidia** 之外，增加另一个 AI 服务器芯片来源。

The maker of Claude has recently been in talks with London-based startup Fractile to buy its inference chips, which aim to run AI models efficiently, when the chips become available next year, according to two people who have spoken to Fractile leaders.

据两名曾与 **Fractile** 负责人交谈的人士透露，**Claude** 的开发商最近一直在与总部位于伦敦的初创公司 **Fractile** 进行谈判，计划在明年其推理芯片上市时进行采购。该芯片旨在高效运行 AI 模型。

Deals such as these would give Anthropic more leverage with suppliers just at the time when its spending on servers and chips is projected to reach tens of billions of dollars a year.

此类交易将使 **Anthropic** 在其服务器和芯片支出预计达到每年数百亿美元之际，拥有更多与供应商博弈的筹码。

The Takeaway

→ Anthropic in talks to buy AI inference chips from UK startup Fractile.

Anthropic 洽谈从英国初创公司 **Fractile** 购买 AI 推理芯片。

→ Anthropic seeks to diversify chip supply and reduce high operational costs.

Anthropic 寻求实现芯片供应多元化，并降低高昂的运营成本。

→ Fractile's potential deal helped as it spoke with investors about raising \$100 million.

Fractile 在与投资者洽谈 1 亿美元融资之际，这项潜在交易为其提供了助力。

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Anthropic has long differentiated itself from other AI developers by renting a variety of server chips to develop and run its technology so it isn't dependent on Nvidia's hardware the way OpenAI and xAI are.

长期以来，**Anthropic** 与其他 AI 开发商的区别在于，它通过租用多种服务器芯片来开发和运行其技术，因此不像 **OpenAI** 和 **xAI** 那样依赖 **Nvidia** 的硬件。

Anthropic also recently agreed to purchase a substantial number of chips made by Google, which Anthropic would use outside Google Cloud data centers, giving it more control over how the hardware works.

Anthropic 最近还同意购买大量由 **Google** 制造的芯片，并将在 **Google Cloud** 数据中心之外使用这些芯片，从而使其能够更自主地控制硬件的运行方式。

The three-year-old Fractile is one of numerous startups aiming to create server chips that run completed AI models more efficiently than Nvidia graphics processing units do. These inference chips rely on static random-access memory, which minimizes the need to shuttle data back and forth to separate high-bandwidth memory chips as GPUs do.

成立三年的 **Fractile** 是众多初创公司之一，其目标是开发比 **Nvidia** 图形处理器（GPU）更高效运行已完成 AI 模型的服务器芯片。这些推理芯片依赖于静态随机存取存储器（SRAM），这能最大限度地减少像 GPU 那样在独立的高带宽内存芯片之间来回传输数据的需求。

Other users of SRAM include Cerebras and startup Groq, which last year licensed technology to Nvidia, which also hired its leaders.

其他使用 SRAM 的公司还包括 **Cerebras** 和初创公司 **Groq**，后者去年将其技术授权给了 **Nvidia**，**Nvidia** 还聘请了其领导层。

AI firms and cloud providers have been desperately trying to create alternatives to Nvidia chips for inference as a way to reduce costs and improve margins. Last year, Anthropic's gross profit margins from running its AI products were lower than it had projected due to higher-than-expected inference costs, an issue OpenAI also experienced. Since then, both companies have focused on ways to lower costs, including by inking new agreements with non-Nvidia AI chip suppliers.

AI 公司和云服务提供商一直致力于寻找 **Nvidia** 推理芯片的替代方案，以降低成本并提高利润率。去年，由于推理成本高于预期，**Anthropic** 运营其 AI 产品的毛利率低于预期，**OpenAI** 也遇到了同样的问题。此后，两家公司都开始专注于降低成本的方法，包括与非 **Nvidia** 的 AI 芯片供应商签署新协议。

Fractile's potential agreement with Anthropic was a big selling point for investors looking at the smaller startup's most recent funding round, which aimed to raise over \$100 million at a \$1 billion-plus valuation, according to another person with knowledge of the round.

据另一位了解融资情况的人士透露，**Fractile** 与 **Anthropic** 的潜在协议是吸引投资者关注这家小型初创公司最近一轮融资的一大卖点。该轮融资的目标是以超过 10 亿美元的估值筹集逾 1 亿美元资金。

Founders Fund, 8VC and Accel have been in talks to invest in the round, the person said.

据知情人士透露，**Founders Fund**、**8VC** 和 **Accel** 一直在洽谈参与本轮投资。

The size of the potential agreement with Anthropic couldn't be learned. Talks are in the early stages and the customer agreement could fall through. Spokespeople from Anthropic and Fractile declined to comment. Spokespeople from Founders Fund, 8VC and Accel didn't respond to a request for comment.

目前尚无法获知与 **Anthropic** 潜在协议的具体规模。谈判尚处于早期阶段，客户协议仍有告吹的可能。**Anthropic** 和 **Fractile** 的发言人均拒绝置评。**Founders Fund**、**8VC** 和 **Accel** 的发言人未回应置评请求。

The deal is won't help with Anthropic's near-term compute needs, since Fractile's chips won't be available to go into data centers until next year at the earliest, Fractile leaders have previously said.

这笔交易无法解决 **Anthropic** 的短期算力需求，因为 **Fractile** 的高管此前曾表示，其芯片最早要到明年才能进入数据中心。

Instead, Anthropic has been inking large cloud deals with Amazon and Google as it raced to keep its systems running while its revenue pace tripled since the end of last year.

相反，由于 **Anthropic** 的收入增速自去年底以来增长了两倍，为了维持系统运行，该公司一直在与亚马逊（**Amazon**）和谷歌（**Google**）签署大型云服务协议。

In April, Anthropic unveiled new agreements to secure hundreds of billions of dollars' worth of servers from those cloud providers, including using the custom chips they develop, though much of it won't come online anytime soon.

今年 4 月，**Anthropic** 披露了与这些云服务提供商达成的新协议，旨在确保获得价值数千亿美元的服务器，其中包括使用它们开发的定制芯片，尽管其中大部分在短期内不会上线。

Nvidia CEO Jensen Huang recently said he regretted not investing earlier in Anthropic, as it might have prevented it from becoming a major customer of Google and Amazon chips. Last fall, Anthropic committed to spending \$30 billion to rent Nvidia servers from Microsoft's Azure cloud in exchange for Nvidia investing \$10 billion and Microsoft investing \$5 billion in the startup.

英伟达（**Nvidia**）首席执行官黄仁勋（**Jensen Huang**）最近表示，他后悔没有早点投资 **Anthropic**，因为这本可以防止其成为谷歌和亚马逊芯片的主要客户。去年秋天，**Anthropic** 承诺斥资 300 亿美元从微软的 **Azure** 云租赁英伟达服务器，作为交换，英伟达向这家初创公司投资了 100 亿美元，微软投资了 50 亿美元。

Anthropic has also considered designing its own inference chips, according to Reuters, a strategy OpenAI and Meta Platforms are also pursuing to lessen their reliance on Nvidia.

据路透社报道，**Anthropic** 还考虑过设计自己的推理芯片，**OpenAI** 和 **Meta Platforms** 也在采取这一策略，以减少对英伟达的依赖。

Anthropic is moving quickly to line up access to AI chips after surging demand for its AI coding and work agents caused a compute crunch. Last month, developers protested its decision to limit some Claude Code customers' ability to use the product during peak hours. Some customers have complained of outages.

在对其 AI 编程和工作代理的需求激增导致算力紧缺后，**Anthropic** 正迅速行动以确保 AI 芯片的供应。上个月，开发者对其限制部分 **Claude Code** 客户在高峰时段使用该产品的决定表示抗议。一些客户还抱怨出现了服务中断的情况。

Fractile was co-founded in late 2022 by Walter Goodwin, an Oxford University AI and robotics doctorate holder who previously worked on robotics at Amazon, and Yuhang Song, who left Fractile in 2024 to found another startup.

Fractile 由 **Walter Goodwin** 和 **Yuhang Song** 于 2022 年底共同创立。**Walter Goodwin** 拥有牛津大学人工智能和机器人学博士学位，此前曾在亚马逊从事机器人相关工作；**Yuhang Song** 则于 2024 年离开 **Fractile** 创办了另一家初创公司。

The company previously raised \$15 million in funding from investors including Kindred Capital, the Nato Innovation Fund and Oxford Science Enterprises.

该公司此前已从 **Kindred Capital**、北约创新基金（**Nato Innovation Fund**）和 **Oxford Science Enterprises** 等投资者手中筹集了 1500 万美元的资金。

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With Anthropic's margins already squeezed by inference costs, can it afford to wait until next year for Fractile's SRAM chips to become available?

由于 **Anthropic** 的利润空间已受到推理成本的挤压，它是否还得起等到明年 **Fractile** 的 **SRAM** 芯片上市？



Can Fractile's SRAM-based chips efficiently support the continuous, high-compute agentic workloads of Claude Code that recently caused severe server shortages?

Fractile 基于 **SRAM** 的芯片能否高效支撑 **Claude Code** 持续、高计算量的智能体工作负载？正是这些负载近期导致了严重的服务器短缺。



Does Fractile's targeted \$1 billion valuation reflect a true SRAM technological breakthrough, or simply the desperate hardware needs of AI giants like Anthropic?

Fractile 寻求的 **10** 亿美元估值，究竟反映了 **SRAM** 技术的真实突破，还是仅仅体现了像 **Anthropic** 这样的 **AI** 巨头对硬件的迫切需求？

